



20 YOUTH SERVICE CORPS 25 LOS ANGELES

The Mayor's Office of Economic Opportunity presents a year-in-review of the 2025 California Volunteers Youth Service Corps program, showcasing the collective progress, partnerships, and workforce impact achieved across the City.

MAY 2026



YOUTH SERVICE CORPS

LETTER TO THE READER

Colleagues and Partners,

Youth Service Corps Los Angeles (**YSC-LA**), funded by California Volunteers Office of the Governor, reflects a deliberate investment in the future of the City of Los Angeles. As part of Mayor Karen Bass's priority to Foster Opportunity, this initiative is designed to provide short-term employment, build a stronger workforce pipeline, connect opportunity to neighborhoods, and ensure that young Angelenos have meaningful access to careers that shape the future of Los Angeles.

In **2025, 2,244 young people** stepped into **structured, paid work experiences** that supported public service, community resilience, and essential city functions. At a time when many communities continue to navigate economic uncertainty and recovery, these opportunities matter deeply. Paid work experiences offer **stability, professional exposure, mentorship, and a tangible pathway toward long-term economic mobility**. For many participants, YSC-LA is not only a first job, but a first step toward seeing themselves as professionals, leaders, and contributors to the civic life of Los Angeles.

This work is made possible through strong **cross-department collaboration and the dedication of community partners** who guide, supervise, and invest in young people every day. I extend my sincere gratitude to the teams who deliver these programs and to the Angelenos whose commitment, resilience, and talent continue to define the success of YSC-LA.

The Mayor's Office of Economic Opportunity remains committed to **expanding access, deepening partnerships, and strengthening YSC-LA as a scalable and equitable workforce strategy for Los Angeles**. The momentum, built through partnership and collaboration, reinforces what is possible when we intentionally align opportunity with community need and invest in the next generation.

Sincerely,

Brenda Shockley
Deputy Mayor, Economic Opportunity
City of Los Angeles

MAY 2026



YOUTH SERVICE CORPS

2025 IN REVIEW



Our Mission

Youth Service Corps Los Angeles (YSC-LA) is a **citywide workforce strategy** designed to expand access to meaningful employment for young Angelenos while strengthening municipal capacity in priority service areas. Through alignment with Mayor Karen Bass' Foster Opportunity priority, YSC-LA connects youth to structured, skill-building work experiences that serve communities and build long-term career pathways.

In Los Angeles, young people from **low-income households, foster care backgrounds, or justice-impacted communities** often face barriers to entering the workforce, including limited access to paid experience, professional networks, and clear pathways into stable careers. YSC-LA addresses these gaps by positioning employment as both an economic intervention and a workforce development strategy, ensuring that opportunity is aligned with community need and future labor demand.

Our Approach

YSC-LA is implemented through a coordinated partnership involving the Mayor's Office of Economic Opportunity and key City departments, supported by a **\$22 million statewide investment through California Volunteers Office of the Governor**. This investment strengthens Los Angeles' youth workforce infrastructure, enabling cross-department collaboration, expanded placements, and enhanced case management capacity.

Participants are placed in **structured, paid roles** across City departments and community-based organizations. Paid interns contribute to high-impact initiatives such as **green jobs and environmental conservation, food recovery and food security, education and tutoring, digital inclusion within public housing sites, public service operations, and skilled trade exposure** in automotive equipment mechanic and warehouse toolroom internships.



These placements are intentionally designed to provide more than entry-level employment. Youth receive **professional development workshops, mentorship, and individualized support through city-funded employment agencies called YouthSource Centers**, which create a comprehensive model that combines wage earning with skill development and long-term career navigation.

For participants, this means gaining a first professional reference, understanding workplace expectations, and accessing pathways into public and community service careers. For neighborhoods, it means expanding local service capacity and reinvesting talent directly into the communities most in need.

Opportunity at Scale

The demand for structured youth employment in Los Angeles continues to outpace available placements. This year, **nearly 8,000 applications** were submitted for YSC-LA opportunities, underscoring both the need for paid work experience and the strong desire among young Angelenos to contribute meaningfully to their communities. This level of interest highlights the importance of maintaining and expanding access to high-quality workforce pathways across the City.

The scale of participation and level of investment reflect the City's commitment to aligning opportunity with community need and advancing workforce equity at scale.

Implementation

YSC-LA is implemented through a coordinated citywide partnership led by the Mayor's Office of Economic Opportunity in collaboration with:

- The Mayor's Office of Community Safety
- The Economic and Workforce Development Department (EWDD)
- The Board of Public Works (BPW)
- The Department of Recreation and Parks (RAP)
- The Community Investment for Families Department (CIFD)
- The Housing Authority of the City of Los Angeles (HACLA)
- The Youth Development Department

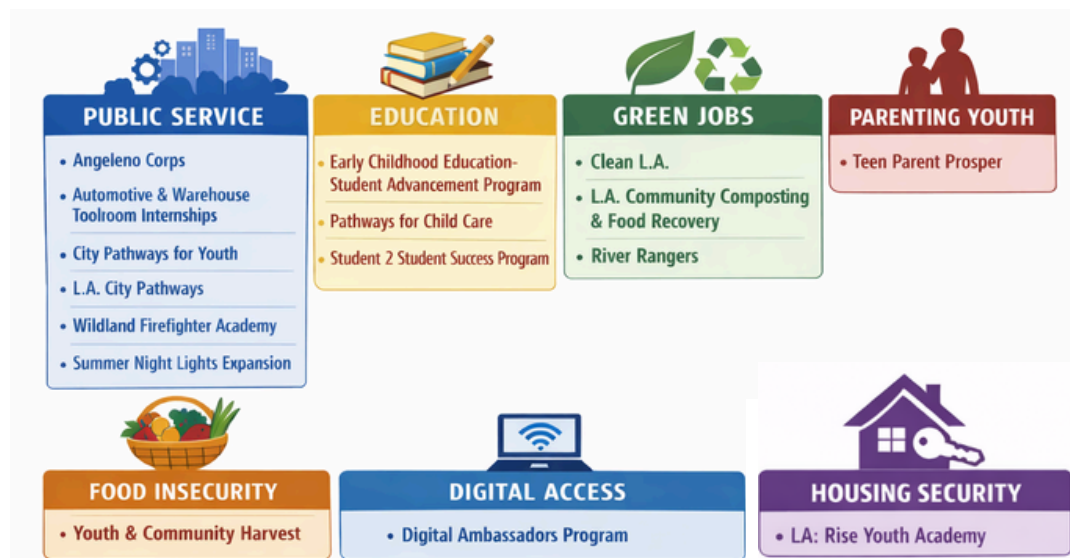
Together, these entities work alongside the City's contracted YouthSource Centers and a broad network of community-based organizations to recruit, enroll, and support participants.

The initiative operates within Los Angeles' broader youth workforce development ecosystem, working closely with YouthSource, FamilySource, and WorkSource Centers; the Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD); the Los Angeles Community College District (LACCD) and a consortium of experienced nonprofit service providers that serve as worksites.

Participants earn stipends or wages ranging from **\$17.87 to \$25.00 per hour** depending on program model, ensuring that work experiences are both meaningful and economically impactful. **In addition to job placement, city departments provided professional development workshops and skills training to prepare participants** for continued success in the workforce.

Ongoing Commitment

Across all projects, the overarching goal remains clear: **connect young job seekers to high-quality workforce programs that enable them not only to secure their first job, but to maintain stable employment and access long-term careers** in public and community service, increasing their lifetime earning potential. To ensure continuous improvement, the Mayor's Office of Economic Opportunity tracks enrollment, completion, and participant outcomes, maintaining a data-driven approach that responds to the evolving needs of youth and the local labor market.



Impact by Numbers

Youth Service Corps Los Angeles (YSC-LA) operated **16 programs across the City**, including one high school-focused initiative. While age eligibility ranged from 16 to 30, the majority of programs served young adults preparing to enter or transition within the workforce.

This year, **7,978 applications were received** for opportunities across the City. The program placed **2,244 youth** over a 12-month period, **surpassing the original goal of 1,682 participants**.

Of the youth placed, **1,280 completed 100 percent of their expected service hours**. Program models ranged from 140 hours to 1,900 hours depending on the initiative. Based on completed service to date, participating youth worked an estimated **368,583 hours** in communities across Los Angeles and **earned approximately \$9.4 million in wages and stipends**. Final accounting is ongoing.

All 2,244 youth placed met low-income eligibility requirements. In addition:

- **143** participants identified as **justice-impacted**
- **126** participants were **current or former foster youth**
- **280** participants identified as **formerly or currently homeless**
- 5 participants identified challenges related to mental health or substance use

Youth contributed across multiple priority areas, often spanning more than one category, including **public service (1,040)**, **education (902)**, **housing security (131)**, **green jobs (124)**, food insecurity (40), and digital access (27). The gender distribution of participants included 63 percent identifying as female, 37 percent as male, and less than 1 percent selecting another gender identity option.

Taken together, these metrics demonstrate more than program volume. They **reflect a workforce model that is reaching young people with the greatest barriers to employment**, converting demand into structured opportunity, and translating public investment into measurable service hours within local communities. As YSC-LA continues to evolve, these data points provide a foundation for targeted growth, expanded regional access, and strengthened long-term workforce pathways.

PERFORMANCE SNAPSHOT

Youth Served

Total Participants

2,244

Figure reflects participants who served one or more days

Goal Completion

Progress

Goal: 1,682

Target Achieved

Completed 100%

1,280

Youth hours fully completed



Earnings

\$9.4 M

*pending final count



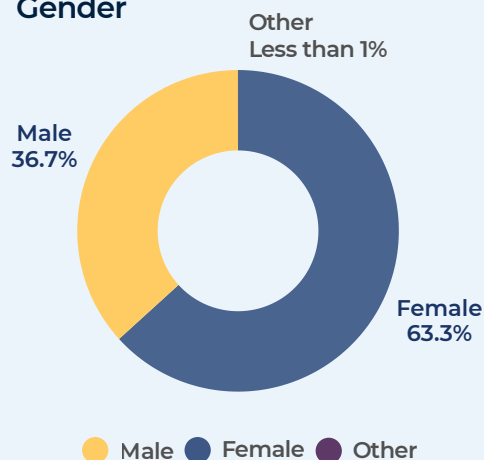
Hours Worked

368,583

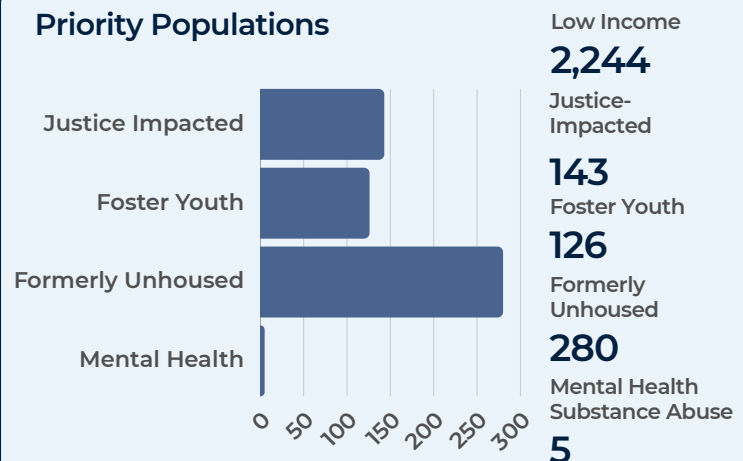
across 16 programs



Gender



Priority Populations



Youth by Focus Areas

1,040



Public Service

124



Green Jobs

902



Education

40



Food Insecurity

131



Housing Security

27



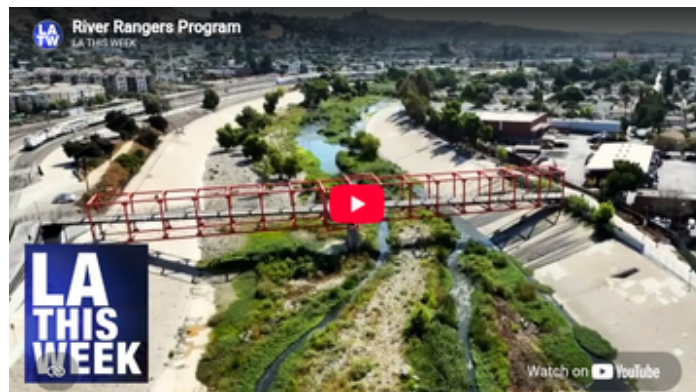
Digital Access

Program Highlights

Behind the data are programs delivering tangible impact across Los Angeles. The videos below highlight how Youth Service Corps Los Angeles (YSC-LA) participants are strengthening communities through environmental stewardship and public service while building career pathways of their own.

Through the Board of Public Works Office of Community Beautification, the L.A. River Rangers continued to show the impact of youth leadership in climate and environmental stewardship. Corps members removed more than **140 tons of weeds**, **cleared 8,000 bulky items**, and **cleaned over 150 illegal dumping sites** along the Los Angeles River, improving neighborhoods and restoring public spaces.

The team also supported fire season vegetation management, led volunteer cleanups in the Sepulveda Basin, and installed native plants near the LAX dunes. A total of **72 youth participated** in the program, with **32 transitioning into employment** after service, reinforcing the River Rangers as both an environmental force and a strong **pathway into climate and public works careers**.



L.A. River Rangers

*Managed by the LA Conservation Corps, a contracted partner, members learn the importance of keeping our environment clean, gain leadership skills, and receive job training.



City Pathways for Youth

*On December 20, 2025, RAP celebrated these young leaders at a graduation ceremony, recognizing their hard work and the bright futures ahead of them

In 2025, the Department of Recreation and Parks continued to shine as a leader in Youth Service Corps, stewarding two impactful programs that are opening real doors for young Angelenos. Through City Pathways to Childcare and City Pathways for Youth, RAP not only provided meaningful work experience, but helped participants see long-term careers in public service and parks as a viable and exciting path forward.

This year, **City Pathways to Childcare** supported 7 interns, with **6 transitioning into part-time employment at RAP** or partner agencies after completing their internship. Meanwhile, **City Pathways for Youth** engaged 82 interns across parks citywide, with **20 moving directly into employment with RAP**. These outcomes reflect more than placements; they represent a growing **pipeline into careers in recreation, childcare, and community-based public service**.



Angeleno Corps

**Angeleno Corps members provides paid employment to L.A. youth as they pursue higher education opportunities*

Student to Student Success (S2S) provides high school students with paid work experience while they support elementary students in after-school settings. Participants are placed at LA's BEST (Better Educated Students for Tomorrow), a City of Los Angeles-affiliated after-school program, where they assist with academic and enrichment activities for younger students.

Through this partnership, participants can transition the following semester into Part-Time Program Helper roles with LA's BEST, **increasing their pay, gaining more flexible hours, and becoming LA's BEST employees**—strengthening both youth workforce pathways and support for elementary students across the City's after-school programs.



Automotive and Warehouse Toolroom Internships

**The L.A. City General Services Department explains the equipment mechanic internship program provided to L.A. youth*

Angeleno Corps is a service learning program where young adults work at community-based organizations while in school or on an educational program full-time.

Members can support community organizations across focus areas such as **education, environmental sustainability, food security, housing stability, economic opportunity, digital inclusion, healthcare access, and immigrant justice**. Through these placements, participants build practical skills, strengthen their connection to their communities, and gain exposure to career pathways in the public and nonprofit sectors.



Student 2 Student

**S2S is the only Youth Service Corps program designed to provide paid work experience for high school youth ages 16–18.*

The **General Services Department (GSD)** plays a critical behind-the-scenes role supporting all departments in the City of L.A., maintaining over **11,000 pieces of equipment** for agencies such as the L.A. Police Department and the L.A. Fire Department. They host a paid **10-week Equipment Mechanic Internship Program** that gives young adults with automotive backgrounds hands-on experience working in fleet repair shops. Interns gain **real-world mechanical skills, professional training, and a certificate of completion** that helps them pursue future city jobs. Through testimonials from long-time employees and former interns, the program is a pathway to stable employment, strong benefits, and long-term career growth within city government, placing an emphasis that even entry-level positions can lead to leadership roles with dedication and hard work.

APPENDIX: PROGRAM DESCRIPTIONS

Angeleno Corps is a **10-month program** that provides 18- to 30-year-olds with the opportunity to gain work experience through service learning, pursue their education, and receive a **\$1,000 monthly stipend**. 350 participants complete their service at a community-based organization in one of six areas: Education and Child Care; Health, Climate, and Environmental Justice; Immigration Assistance; Nutrition and Food Justice; Technology and Digital Assistance; and Housing Rights Advocacy. 50+ community-based organizations will host Corps members and provide direct work experience and supervision at their worksites.

The **Automotive and Warehouse Toolroom Worker Apprenticeship/Internships** provide **148 hours of on-the job training to 10 high school or college students, ages 16-30**. Created as a potential pathway opportunity into City employment, students participate in a 9-week internship with the City's General Service Department and, if successful, will receive a certificate of completion that details the competencies acquired at the end of the program.

The **City Pathways for Youth** program provides young people between the **ages of 16-30 years** old with the opportunity to learn about careers in the City of Los Angeles' Recreation and Parks Department. Interns are placed at recreation centers and park sites across the city, working alongside recreational and maintenance professionals to create a welcoming environment for the local community. They receive hands-on training and supervision to support afterschool programs, sports/recreation programs, and other community engagement activities.

Clean L.A. is a **12-month, full-time employment** program for young adults between the **ages of 18-30** to help clean and green the City of Los Angeles as a pathway to a full-time career. The program focuses on employing job-seeking Angelenos to perform community beautification and street clean-up services in areas of the city with the greatest need. Work responsibilities include, but are not limited to: weed abatement, cleaning/removing loose litter, and clearing bulky items from the public right-of-way.

Digital Ambassadors are HACLA resident leaders between the **ages of 18-30** who support their communities in addressing the digital divide. Participants are **paid \$20.00 an hour** to assist low-income and senior households with acquiring low-cost internet or digital devices and navigating online resources such as virtual learning, employment opportunities, and tele-health services.

The **Early Childhood Education Student Advancement Program** is an internship and mentorship program for students enrolled in a post-secondary educational institution majoring in the child development (or closely related) field. Students will receive training in child behavior and psychology, communication, and problem-solving, along with one-on-one mentorship support and leadership development. Students can also participate in the ECE Co-generational Connection Program (ECE-CCPro) that connects them with mentors using a Sesame Street-inspired curriculum. In partnership with the Child Development Consortium of Los Angeles (CCDLA), students are placed in paid internships to receive practical, hands-on experience with infants and toddlers at child care sites.



The **L.A. City Pathways** program is an internship program designed to provide young adults with invaluable exposure to a wide range of career opportunities available in the City of Los Angeles. Participants earn the minimum wage and have the privilege of working closely with experienced City employees who serve as their mentors. This immersive program, led by the Mayor's Office of Economic Opportunity provides students with up to **750 paid work hours** to support the operations of various departments through administration, project management, community engagement, and communications.

Designed as part of SB 1383, **L.A. Community Composting and Food Recovery** is an 800-hour job program that will hire Angelenos **between 18-26 years old to maintain community composting sites and gardens, manage surplus food and food scraps, and prevent edible food from becoming waste.** Participants are paid and trained in compost and soil management, native plants and species, OSHA 10, CPR/first aid, and other job readiness skills. Work crews support local food banks and food suppliers to deliver edible food to households facing food insecurity, diverting thousands of pounds of food waste from landfills as a result. This program provides hands-on skills development in an outdoor setting and offers opportunities to gain career certifications in the sustainability/green jobs sector.

The **Los Angeles Regional Initiative for Social Enterprise (LA:RISE) Youth Academy** is a **250-hour work experience program focused on improving housing, education, and employment outcomes for unhoused or housing-insecure Angelenos between the ages of 18-30.** Participants will have the opportunity to get paid, via transitional employment at participating social enterprises. Placement sites include retail, social services, afterschool programs, facilities maintenance, information technology, education, entertainment, and the culinary field.

L.A. River Rangers is a youth employment initiative serving young people **ages 16-26** who are committed to environmental stewardship and public service. Participants support the maintenance and enhancement of 18 miles of the Los Angeles River, contributing critical operational services across public paths, trails, and bridges within City boundaries. As the first program of its kind to provide coordinated services across the City's L.A. River public spaces, River Rangers strengthen both community infrastructure and workforce pathways in the green jobs sector.

Wildland Firefighter Academy provides general training and work experience to prepare low-income and justice impacted Los Angeles City residents for entry-level positions in wildland firefighting and urban forestry. Over an six-week period, participants complete **320 hours of structured training and work experience preparation, including fire behavior education, safety protocols, physical conditioning, and teamwork exercises aligned with industry standards.** Upon successful completion of the program, trainees receive a **\$3,000 stipend** in recognition of their commitment and to help support their transition into employment opportunities within the field.

The **Pathways for Child Care** program provides living-wage career opportunities for early childhood educators while expanding access to licensed child care facilities in Los Angeles. The program will provide **200-hour child care work experience and training.** All participants receive training in mandated reporting, CPR for infants and toddlers, and preschool curriculum. Practical experience is gained in lesson development and classroom management, and interns attend professional development workshops specific to the child care setting.

The **Student to Student Success** program provides **job skills training and paid employment** to high-need students who serve as tutors to younger siblings who have struggled academically as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic. Employed students tutor at least one of their siblings or a school-aged relative living in the same household after school and/or on weekends. The purpose of the program is two-fold: to reverse disproportionate learning loss experienced by our most vulnerable younger students; and to provide paid work experience and career exploration to older students to prepare them for essential employment in the education and childcare field. Program serves youth 14-24 years of age

The **Summer Night Lights Expansion** program hires **young adults ages 16-24** to coordinate activities at 11 City parks and recreation centers to provide youth and families with fun gathering spaces during the summer months. Participants work **16-40 hours a week, for up to 480 hours total, and can earn a wage of up to \$22.00 an hour.**

The **Teen Parent Prosper Program** provides part-time employment to pregnant or parenting teens (ages 16-19), combining work experience through the City's YouthSource Centers and wraparound services through the City's FamilySource Centers. Participants will receive **paid work experience and enhancement services for 600 hours of job training and work experience.** Supportive services include childcare assistance to support employment, financial literacy education, and parenting and child development workshops.

The **Youth & Community Harvest** Program offers work experience and professional development to **youth and young adults, ages 16 to 30**, who are passionate about addressing the issue of food insecurity. Participants receive a **bi-weekly stipend of \$480 for a maximum of 200 hours** of internship service with community-based organizations that lead urban farms, community gardens, and farmers markets.

Community Partners

City Agencies








YouthSource Centers



ALL PEOPLES
COMMUNITY CENTER



BROTHERHOOD
Crusade



Catholic
Charities
of Los Angeles, Inc.



CRCD COALITION for
RESPONSIBLE
COMMUNITY
DEVELOPMENT



ESPERANZA
El Proyecto del Barrio



Goodwill
Southern
California



LOS ANGELES
CONSERVATION
CORPS



LOS
ANGELES
LGBT
CENTER



North East Trees



para los niños
for the children

**+60 Other
Community
Partners**

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